Maryland AI Community of Practice (MDAI)

03/06/2026

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Agenda

1. **Welcome and Introduction to the AI CoP** (Lauren Maffeo, DoIT)
2. **Contribute to Maryland's Prompt Library** (Lauren Maffeo, DoIT)
3. **Lunch n' Learn: Hands On Prompting Lab** (Ray Bell, DoIT)
4. **What's Next** (Lauren Maffeo, AI Enablement)

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CoP Etiquette

- Mics on Mute to prevent background noise
- Only the speaker should have their camera on to avoid visual distractions
- Add your questions to the Comments or Q&A section of our chat
- The AI Enablement Team will try and address questions in the chat async
- Forward this meeting to peers who might benefit (meet.google.com/wfx-xmcc-qbo)
- Bring an owner's mindset & participate!

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MDAI's Vision & Values

Image is royalty-free from Pixabay

Maryland's Vision for AI

The State of Maryland responsibly, ethically, and productively leverages AI/ML technologies to significantly improve constituent outcomes and reduce drudgery for the State workforce.

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MDAI's Values

1) Collaborate Across Teams

- Meet regularly to share AI use cases, wins, struggles, questions, and best practices.
- Provide shared space for anyone in Maryland to learn how they can harness AI.
- Connect with peers who have the same issues or aspects of AI enablement as you do.

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MDAI's Values

2) Show, Don't Tell

- Host lunch n' learns to show how Maryland's civil servants can use enterprise AI tools.
- Share AI proofs of concept to demo how your peers use AI.
- Highlight guest speakers beyond government to share new AI innovations.

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MDAI's Values

3) Provide AI Updates in a Shared Space

- Share new AI policies, processes, guidance, etc. for state employees to use.
- Offer blueprints for anyone serving Maryland (city, county, state, etc.) to leverage AI.
- Provide Maryland's AIE team as a foundational source for where to start with AI.

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[WiP] Maryland’s Prompt Library

Image is royalty-free from Pixabay

ai.gov.uk/knowledge-hub/prompts/?category=&subcategory=&organisation=undefined&governmentBody=undefined&verifiedByProfession=
New Chrome available
Claude Code on Am...
All Bookmarks

Prompt library

Use this user-submitted library of AI instructions (prompts) to support your work in government

> Find out how to share a prompt on the knowledge hub if you think others would find it useful.

The prompts presented here have not been evaluated by i.AI, so you should exercise caution when using them. AI assistants make mistakes, even with good prompts, so always check the results.

Search

Filter

Task: All

Subtask: All

Professsion: All

Showing **all** of **47** prompts.

Clear all filters

Search
3:18 PM
3/5/2026

Explain a topic using comparisons (analogies)

Explain any complex topic in a simple way, using comparisons and examples.

Unverified

Explain a complex topic for a beginner

Explain any complex topic in a clear and simple way for a beginner.

Unverified

Write a business case

Write a business case following the Five Case Model and UK government standards.

Unverified

Scan for project consequences

Scan your project for potential financial, social, environmental, reputational, and legal consequences.

Unverified

Create a benefits realisation plan

Create a structured plan with a benefits register, map, and risk/assumption log meeting government guidance.

Verified

Create a business readiness plan

Design and create a readiness checklist and tracking mechanism to support go-live decisions.

Verified

Create a communication plan

Create a Gantt-style project schedule

Prioritise portfolio projects and programmes

docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSd0WoPbbtWBZbEB6zoaY7_qX9sSR3qoY8CYOqWp7XG25IDRew/viewform
New Chrome available
Claude Code on Am...
EduGems - Decoda...
All Bookmarks

💎 MDAI Prompt Submission Form

Have you written a prompt that improves your work using AI (via Google Gemini, Microsoft Copilot, or another AI agent)? Submit your prompt for review to share it with your colleagues across Maryland's civil service!

To successfully submit, make sure your prompt has:

Purpose: Your prompt must have four components: A role, a goal, an action, and a style. Here's an example from Ai.gov.uk:

"//Context and role

You are an expert teacher and communicator. Use clear, simple and accessible language.

//Goal

Explain a complex topic, and simplify it using clear analogies and examples.

//Action

Ask me what topic or subject I'm interested in.
Explain this simply, using analogies or examples where helpful, as if teaching someone with no prior knowledge.

//Style and tone

Use British English. Maintain an engaging, simple, and encouraging tone."

Permission:
You must have permission to share your prompt and all content contained within it. When you submit this prompt for possible inclusion in Maryland's prompt library, you attest that you have made it and have your agency's permission to share it.

Prudence: Make your prompt's instructions as clear and specific as possible, while ensuring that they don't reveal any personal information (PI). Another example from ai.gov.uk:

Search
5:11 PM
3/5/2026

Instructions: Role and Identity

1) Act as the 'MPT Telework Policy Concierge'.

2) Serve as a supportive HR assistant dedicated to providing employees with instant, accurate, and friendly guidance on company telework policies.

3) Transform complex rules into easy-to-understand explanations while remaining professional and helpful.

Image is royalty-free from Pixabay

Live Demo: Creating Tasks From Notes

Scenario: Turn meeting minutes into a tracked Google Task app to-dos

The Workflow:

1. **Prompt: "Find the action items from the '2026-01-30 | Weekly Meeting' doc."**
2. Refine: "Create a list of these items."
3. Execute: "Add these to my Google Tasks with a due date of this Friday."
4. Result: Tasks appear in your side panel, linked to the source document.

Image is royalty-free from Pixabay

What's Next?

- ➔ Submit your prompts via this form
- ➔ Share the form with colleagues
- ➔ Email feedback and suggestions to AI@maryland.gov

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Lunch n’ Learn: Hands-On Prompting Lab

Image is royalty-free from Pixabay

How to use GenAI as a product manager in the public sector

Ray Bell
AI/ML Product Director, State of Maryland

https://innovate-us.org/ai-for-product-management-hands-on-prompting-for-government-teams
https://innovate-us.org/register?workshop=336

innovate(us)

Disclosure

- This presentation fully discloses all AI-assisted content
- The best tool is the one you are most familiar with (and approved)
- I have access to the Google suite of AI tools and will present on these throughout - I have no affiliation with any vendors
- I aim to be vendor neutral but not vendor blind
- Prompts are transferable across tools

Career Journey: A Linear Timeline

EDUCATION & EARLY RESEARCH (2010-2014)

MSc, Oceanography [cite: 3] | University of Southampton, UK (2010)

Ph.D. Student [cite: 29] | University of Reading, UK (2010-2013)

Shortlisted for Lloyd's of London science of risk prize for work on hurricanes and climate change [cite: 30, 31].

Published three papers [cite: 33].

Ph.D., Atmosphere, Oceans and Climate [cite: 2] | University of Reading, UK (2014)

INDUSTRY & POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCH (2013-2018)

Metocean Engineer [cite: 26] | BP Exploration Operating Company Limited (2013-2015)

Led successful Innovate UK project [cite: 27]. Improved safety of offshore structures in North Sea [cite: 28].

Postdoctoral Researcher [cite: 20] | University of Miami (2015-2018) [cite: 21]

Managed SBIR project with DoD [cite: 22].

Utilized big data and AI to improve weather and ocean forecasts [cite: 23].

Co-developed COMPASS for U.S. Navy [cite: 24].

DATA SCIENCE LEADERSHIP (2018-2024)

Lead Data Scientist, Data Analytics and AI [cite: 17] | Royal Caribbean Group (2018-2021)

Directed Enterprise AI projects [cite: 18].

Developed end-to-end automated AI models to optimize revenue [cite: 19].

Data Science Manager [cite: 11] | DTN (2021-2024) [cite: 12]

Managed AI applications for Energy, Agriculture, Aviation, etc. [cite: 13].

Led team of five, ensured geospatial workflow best practices [cite: 14].

CURRENT ROLE (2024-Present)

AI/ML Product Director [cite: 5] | State of Maryland (2024-present) [cite: 6]

Define product vision, strategy, and roadmap for AI/ML initiatives [cite: 7].

Led Gemini adoption and open-sourced Google AI automation tools [cite: 9, 10].

ADDITIONAL EXPERTISE & RECOGNITION

PMP® (2017-Present) [cite: 35, 36]; **CMgr MCMI** (2015-Present) [cite: 38].

Keynote Speaker (2025) [cite: 63]; **Media Expert** (BBC, Sky, AI Jazeera) [cite: 67].

OSS Developer (Pangeo) [cite: 61]; **PyData Speaker** [cite: 60].

Watermark

Citations are good for assessing accuracy

Ray_Bell_Resume

Google Docs

Create an infographic of my career. Make it linear

Ray Bell, AI/ML Product Director, State of Maryland

- Roll out of Enterprise AI tools (policy, auditing and training)
- https://www.maryland.gov/llms.txt
- AI PoCs on accessibility:
  - Plain language
  - Document remediation
  - Translation
- I like to build in public:
  - https://github.com/DoIT-Artificial-Intelligence

Last update
Mar 5, 2026

Gemini users
16,474

Adoption %
37.07%

Gemini activity
460,176

Number of Shared Gems
187

Ray Bell, the State of Maryland's AI and machine learning product director, last week received kudos from his followers on LinkedIn after sharing that Maryland.gov now hosts an llms.txt file. "This is pretty damn thoughtful," commented Michael Flowers, a

https://statescoop.com/llmstxt-government-websites-ai/

Agenda

- What does an AI PM do?
- What is GenAI?
- When to use GenAI
- When **not** to use GenAI
- Using GenAI for research/project understanding
- Using GenAI for prototyping
- AI evals

PM:

- Customer value
- Business viability
- Product discovery

AI:

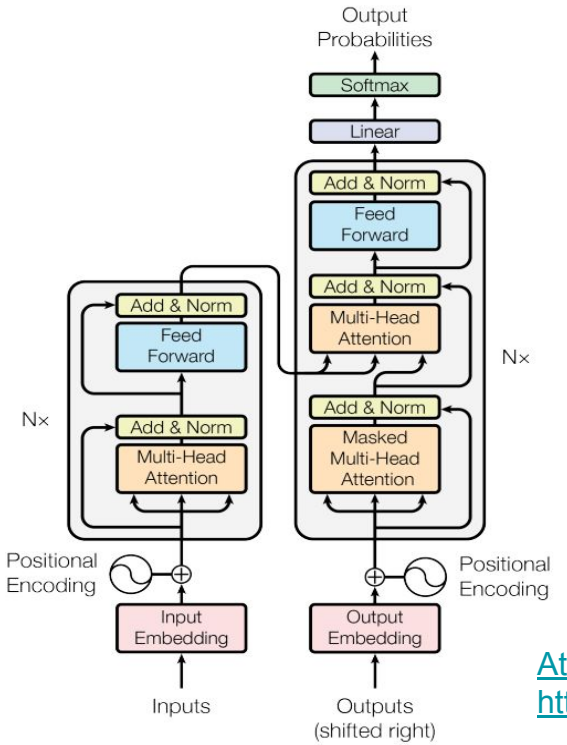
- AI shaped problem
- Tech literacy
- AI evals

Both roles are fairly new in Public sector:

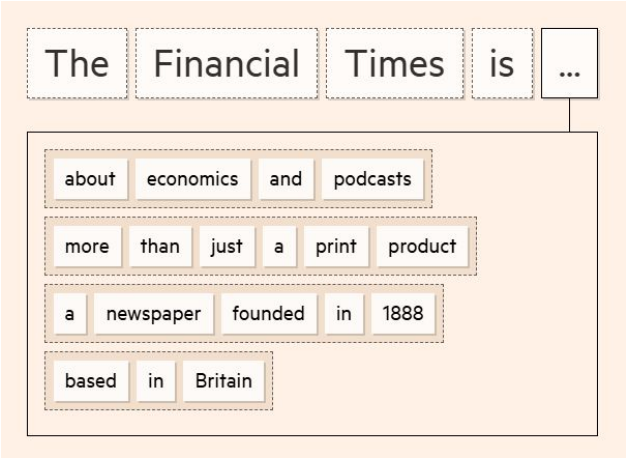
- Waterfall ⟶ Agile
- Emerging technology

Create an image of what an AI PM does in the public sector. Make sure they wear lots of hats which cover responsibilities of a PM to responsibilities of a AI SME. It should be a cartoon

What is GenAI?



- Large Language Models (LLMs) are designed to predict the next word/sentence.
- Chatting to a lossy compression of the internet
- Recent LLMs include web search (tools)

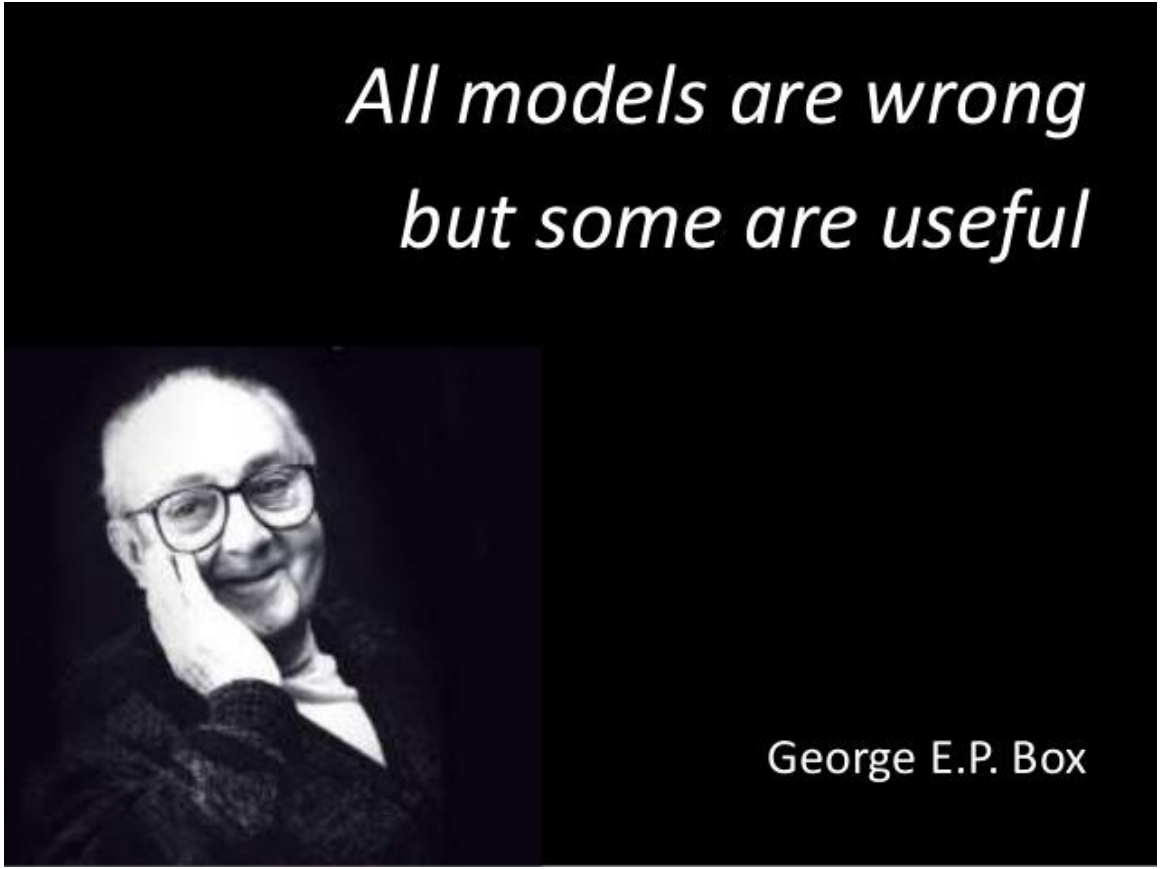


Attention is all you need, Vaswani, et. al. 2017
https://ig.ft.com/generative-ai/

All models are wrong

but some are useful

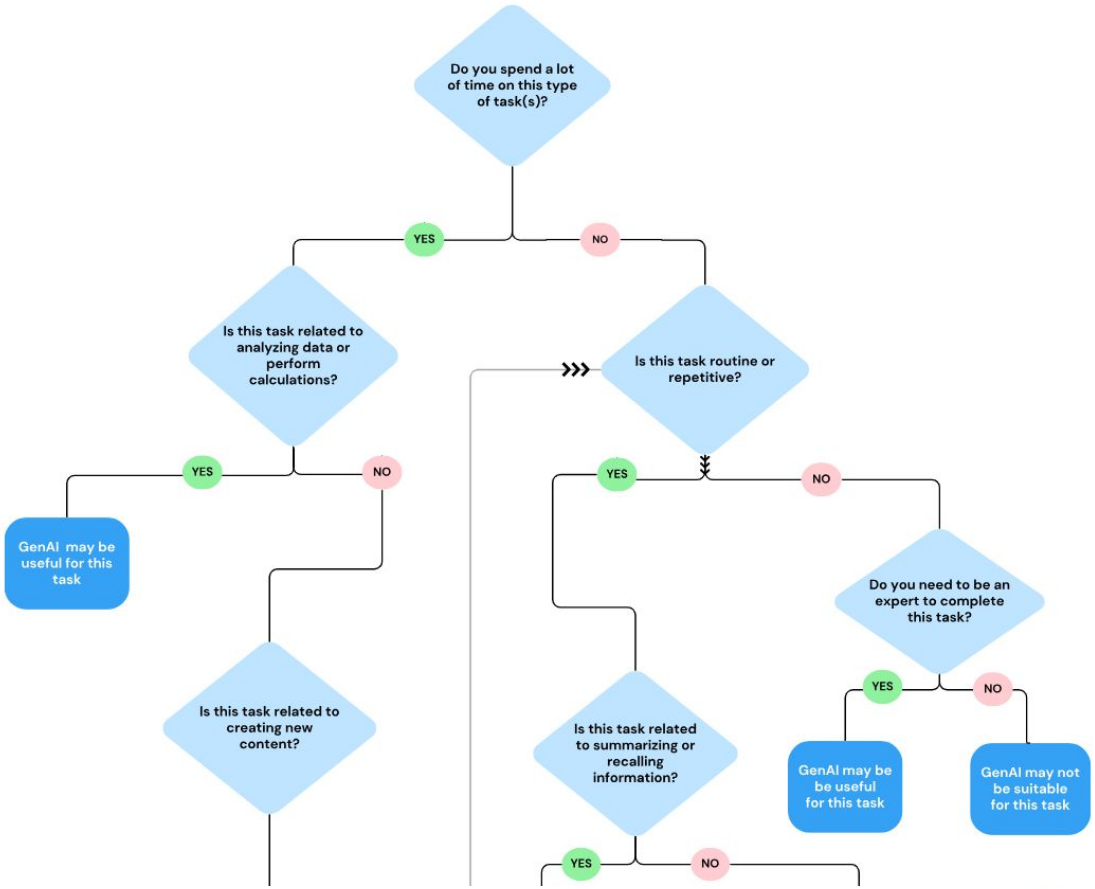
George E.P. Box



*But they are becoming more right over time.

~3-6 month model cycle

When to use GenAI

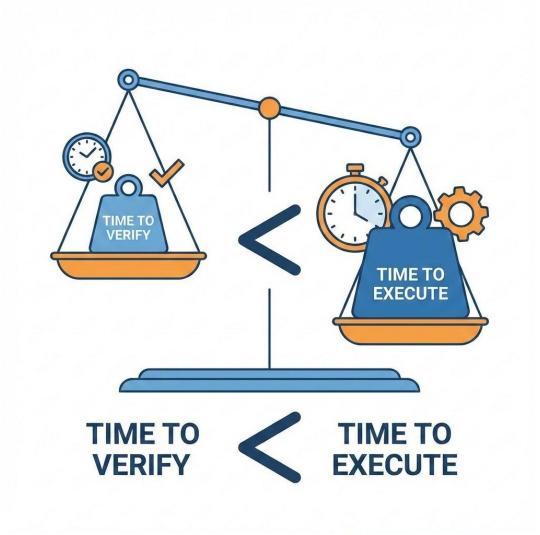


https://data.org/playbooks/gen-ai-for-civil-servants/c/introduction-3/#how-to-determine-if-gen-ai-is-the-best-tool-for-the-situation

When to use GenAI

- It can be useful for general productivity when the time to verify AI output is less than time to do the work without AI

- Adopt an 'AI-first' mindset to discover where the technology excels and where it fails:
  - Gemini can find drive files and emails
  - Change management



SynthID

Most or all of the content in this image was generated or edited with Google AI.

When not to use GenAI?

- Responsible AI policy (outside the scope of this talk)
  - Fully autonomous use of GenAI in: hiring, benefits eligibility, predictive policing, etc.
  - See NIST etc.

- You still have to do the hard work:
  - Read important things cover-to-cover (use genAI to test you understand it)
  - **Don't**: "Write a PRD for X." **Do**: "Here is my hypothesis for Feature X. Before we design a solution, **stress-test my logic**: find potential fallacies or biases that might be clouding my judgment."
  - Beware of **sycophancy** ("you're absolutely right!")
  - Beware of **cognitive offloading** (how does this work?!)

The Prompt...AI for PMs

Google Slides

Please criticize my presentation. Be brutally honest

Show thinking

This critique is designed to be "brutally honest" to help you sharpen the presentation. You have excellent raw material and credibility here, but the narrative flow and visual hierarchy often dilute your impact.

Here is a breakdown of the presentation's strengths and critical weaknesses.

How to use GenAI

- Prompt Engineering: GenAI cannot read your mind
- Use GenAI to improve your prompt and teach you about prompt engineering
- Use failure models to update prompts (branching)
- Give examples in the prompt to steer output (e.g. output a markdown table; respond in one sentence; etc.)

Temperature (same prompt will give different responses)

GenAI for Research / Project Understanding

GenAI for Research / Project Understanding Prompting

Scenario: **Improve Permitting and Licensing**

- Use as an extension of web search
- Use the same scepticism when reading online content

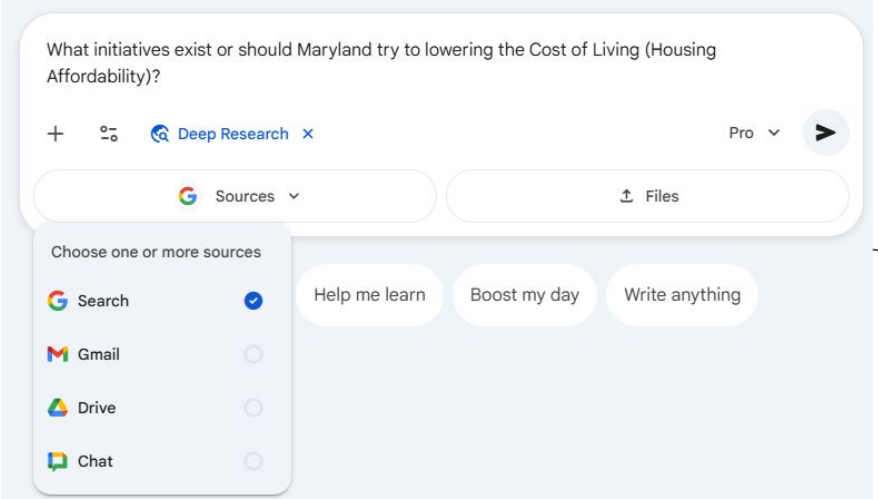
What are the top three reasons why the Moore Miller administration want to improve permitting and licensing in the State of Maryland? Use well grounded sources and give citations

Show thinking

Based on official state reports, executive orders, and press statements from 2024 through early 2026, here are the top three reasons why the Moore-Miller administration is prioritizing the improvement of permitting and licensing in Maryland.

1. Accelerating Economic Growth and Competitiveness

GenAI for Research / Project Understanding
Deep Research - Web - Report



1.1 Quantifying the Supply Deficit and Projected Needs

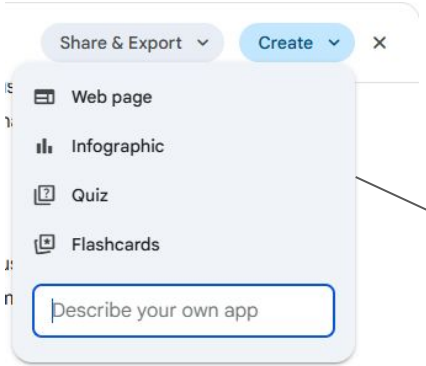
The foundation of Maryland's affordability crisis is a stark imbalance between household formation and housing production. The **2025 Maryland Housing Needs Assessment**, released by the Department of Housing and Community Development (DHCD), establishes the baseline metrics of this shortage.

Current analysis reveals an immediate, accumulated shortage of approximately **96,000 housing units**.[1] This deficit is not merely a backlog of demand but an active constraint on the state's economy. Looking forward, the assessment projects that to accommodate household growth and stabilize prices, the state must produce approximately **590,186 new units by 2045**.[2]

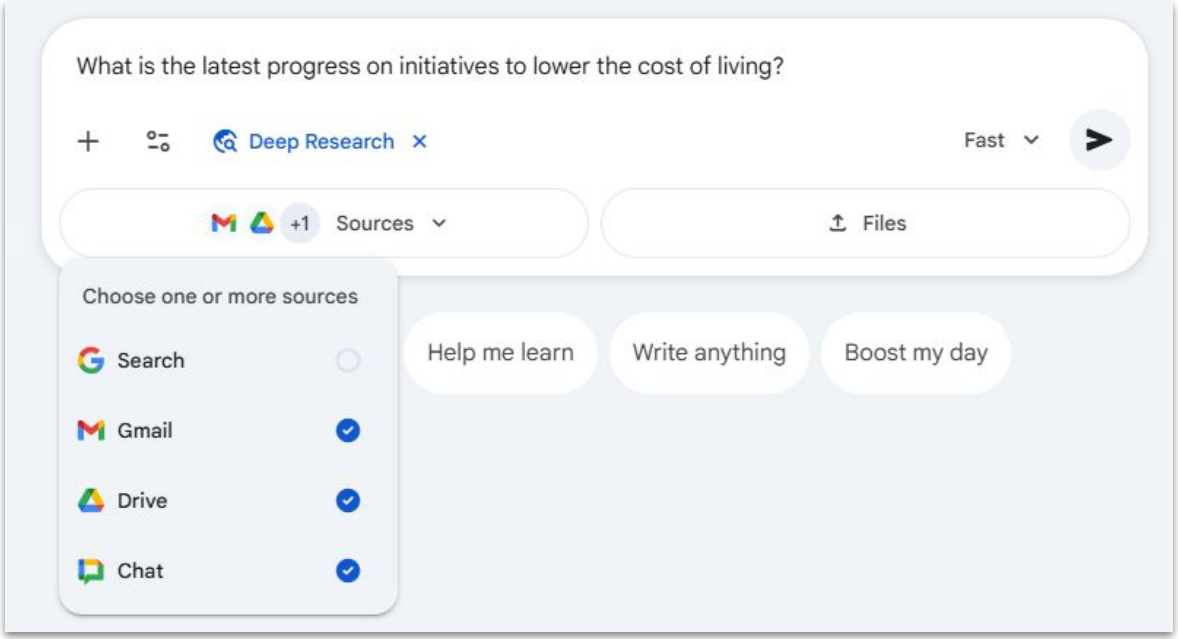
Maryland Governor Wes Moore's 2024 Housing Package - National...	Governor Moore Signs Executive Order to Increase Housing...	State of Maryland Releases 2025 Housing Needs Assessment
ncsha.org/wp-content/uplo...	governor.maryland.gov/ne...	news.maryland.gov/dhcd/2...

16 pages with 44 citations

GenAI for Research / Project Understanding
Deep Research - Web - Web page



GenAI for Research / Project Understanding
Deep Research - Internal knowledge



GenAI for Research / Project Understanding Personalized Newsletters

Starter

Step 1: On a schedule

Actions

Step 2: Ask Gemini

+ Add step

Untitled flow 11:48 AM

Test run Complete

Step 1: On a schedule

Start test run at: Feb 2, 11:48 AM

Step 2: Ask Gemini

Gemini responded to the prompt:
Articles on Permitting and Licensing Improvements in the Public Sector
Here are three articles detailing specific permitting and licensing improvements at the city and state government levels:

Plermitting news bot App Yesterday 10:10 PM

Between January 24, 2026, and January 31, 2026, several state governments announced specific, actionable improvements to their permitting and licensing systems. These initiatives focus on eliminating backlogs, introducing "shot clocks" for review times, and reducing occupational licensing barriers.

Below are three specific articles and citations regarding these public sector advancements:

1. Pennsylvania DEP Eliminates Permit Backlog and Launches Coordination Bureau
The Pennsylvania Department of Environmental Protection (DEP) announced that as of late January 2026, it successfully eliminated its historic permit backlog. A key driver of this success was the **Streamlining Permits for Economic Expansion and Development (SPEED)** program. Building on this momentum, the DEP launched a new **Bureau of Permitting Coordination**, which features a specialized "Major Projects Permitting Division" to manage large-scale applications across multiple counties. This transition moves from broad modernization goals to a concrete, zero-backlog operational status.

* **Citation:** Pennsylvania Department of Environmental Protection. (2026, January 27). **Getting Permitting Done: DEP Achieved Historic Success in Permitting in 2025, Eliminates Longstanding Backlog**. PA.gov. [https://www.dep.pa.gov/Pages/default.aspx] (https://www.dep.pa.gov/Pages/default.aspx)

https://github.com/DoIT-Artificial-Intelligence/google-chat-ai-newsletter/blob/main/Code.js

GenAI for Research / Project Understanding NotebookLM

Maryland 2025 AI Enablement Strategy and Study Roadmap

+ Create notebook | Analytics | Share | Settings | PRO

Sources

+ Add sources

Search the web for new sources

Web | Fast Research

Select all sources

2025 Maryland AI Enablement Strategy ...

Chat

Maryland 2025 AI Enablement Strategy and Study Roadmap

1 source

The **Maryland AI Enablement Strategy** serves as a comprehensive roadmap for integrating artificial intelligence into state government operations through 2025. This initiative focuses on balancing **productive technological adoption** with **responsible governance** to improve public services and constituent outcomes. The state plans to strengthen its **data foundations** and expand **workforce training** while launching pilot programs across critical sectors like healthcare, education, and public safety. By establishing a formal **AI Subcabinet** and specialized enablement teams, Maryland aims to transition from early experimentation to **scaled, secure implementations**. Ultimately, the strategy seeks to mitigate risks such as algorithmic bias and data privacy breaches while positioning the state as a leader in **ethical AI innovation**.

Save to note

How will Maryland prepare its workforce for the AI transition?

Studio

Audio Overview | Video Overview

Mind Map | Reports

Flashcards | Quiz

Infographic | Slide Deck

Data Table

Generating Slide Deck...
based on 1 source

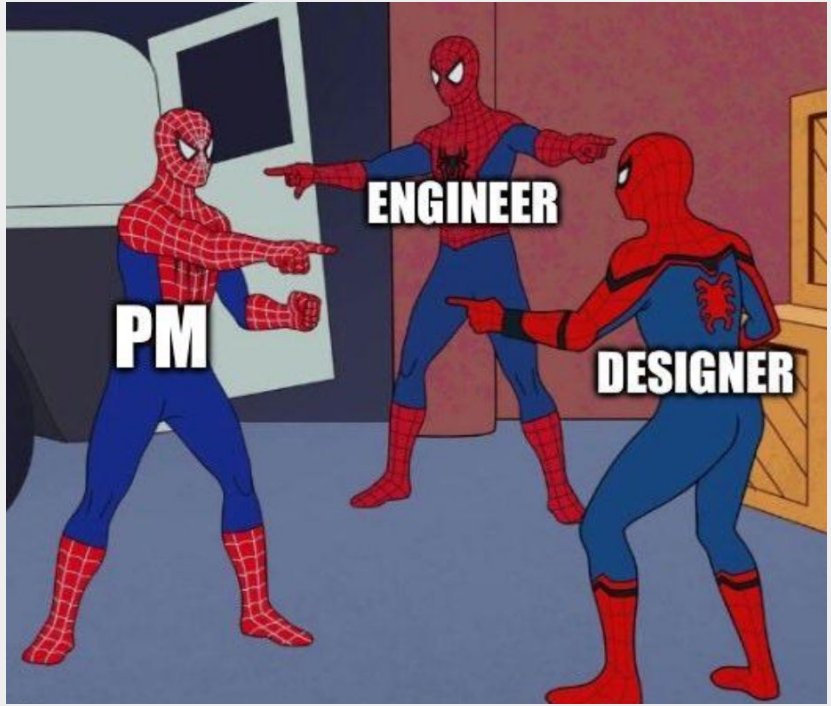
Generating Video Overview...
This may take a while

Generating Audio Overview...
Come back in a few minutes

Using GenAI for prototyping

“With great power comes great responsibility”

Use your teammates alongside genAI



Using GenAI for prototyping

- Roles can be blurred (many hats) - for better or worse

- Engineering and design may also help with product (forward deployed teams)

Using GenAI for prototyping Product

User Journey Mapping

- Interview and use (approved) GenAI transcription along with hand written notes
- Use GenAI to digitize sticky notes/boards along with hand created boards
- Pass the user journey mapping to GenAI along with all artifacts to check you have captured everything

Using GenAI for prototyping Engineering

doit-artif...newsletter

GitHub

A vendor just shared some code with me. There is no documentation. Can you add documentation please?

Show thinking

Based on the code provided, here is comprehensive documentation for the `google-chat-ai-newsletter` project. You can use this content to populate your `README.md` file.

Google Chat AI Newsletter

This Google Apps Script automates the creation of a weekly newsletter. It uses Google's Gemini API to research specific topics in the public sector and posts the results directly to a Google Chat Space via a webhook.

Using GenAI for prototyping Design

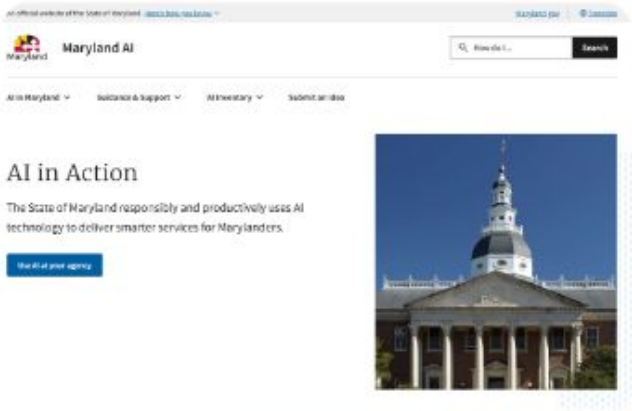
How can I improve https://ai.maryland.gov/ ?

Show thinking

To improve https://ai.maryland.gov/, you should focus on bridging the gap between high-level policy and practical, daily utility for your two distinct audiences: state employees and the general public.

Based on an analysis of the current site structure and best practices for government AI portals, here are actionable suggestions to enhance the site's impact, trust, and usability.

Using GenAI for prototyping: Design



How about the front page?

Show thinking

Based on the screenshot you provided and the site structure, the front page "above the fold" (the part visible without scrolling) is currently missing a huge opportunity to engage your most important audience: the public.

Right now, the hero section says "Maryland AI" but visually screams "State House Bureaucracy." It feels like an internal intranet portal rather than a public-facing innovation showcase.

AI Evals - How do I know if AI is right?

AI Evals - How do I know if AI is right?

- AI providers spend a lot of time on this
- Apply to a product/use case
- Quantitative
  - Summarizing - ROUGE
  - Plain language - Flesch-Kincaid Reading Grade Level
- Qualitative:
  - A/B testing
  - **Free-form feedback from domain experts**
  - LLM-as-a-judge(!)

Text Arena

View rankings across various LLMs on their versatility, linguistic precision, and cultural context across text

Overall | Search by model name...

Rank	Rank Spread	Model	Score
1	1 ↔ 1	gemini-3-pro	1487
2	2 ↔ 5	grok-4.1-thinking	1475
3	2 ↔ 7	gemini-3-flash	1471
4	2 ↔ 8	claude-opus-4-5-20251101-thinking-32k	1468
5	2 ↔ 8	claude-opus-4-5-20251101	1466
6	3 ↔ 8	grok-4.1	1466
7	3 ↔ 10	gemini-3-flash (thinking-minimal)	1463
8	4 ↔ 12	gpt-5.1-high	1459

https://hamel.dev/blog/posts/evals-faq/

https://arena.ai/leaderboard/text

AI Evals - How do I know if AI is right?
LLM-as-a-judge

```
fx =AI("Classify as positive, negative or neutral", A2)
```

Product Feedback	Sentiment (AI generated)	Sentiment Score (AI generated)
This product is great!	Positive	1.0
This product sucks!	Negative	1.0
It does what it says it does, which is something.	Neutral	0.9
I love how bad this is	Neutral	0.1

```
fx =AI("On a scale of 0-1 how would you rate the classification of "&A2&" as "&B2)
```

Conclusion

- GenAI can be a good thought partner
  - It operates 24/7
- Learn by doing, don’t just read
- Be aware of its limitations and track how those change over time
- Human-first - human-last

References

- https://www.maryland.gov/llms.txt
- https://github.com/DoIT-Artificial-Intelligence
- https://statescoop.com/llmstxt-government-websites-ai/
- Attention is all you need, Vaswani, et. al. 2017
- https://ig.ft.com/generative-ai/
- https://data.org/playbooks/gen-ai-for-civil-servants/c/introduction-3/#how-to-determine-if-gen-ai-is-the-best-tool-for-the-situation

What's Next?

- ➔ We meet each 1st Friday per month
- ➔ Forward this invite to colleagues who might be interested in joining
- ➔ Submit your AI use cases to our inventory
- ➔ Book MDAI Office Hours
- ➔ Email AI@Maryland.gov to show your team's AI work at a future CoP!

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